```
$person = new Person('Fred', 35);
```

These arguments are passed to the class's *constructor*, a special function that initializes the properties of the class.

A constructor is a function with the same name as the class in which it is defined. Here's a constructor for the Person class:

```
class Person {
    function Person ($name, $age) {
        $this->name = $name;
        $this->age  = $age;
    }
}
```

PHP does not provide for an automatic chain of constructors; that is, if you instantiate an object of a derived class, only the constructor in the derived class is automatically called. For the constructor of the parent class to be called, the constructor in the derived class must explicitly call the constructor. In this example, the Employee class constructor calls the Person constructor:

```
class Person {
  var $name, $address, $age;

  function Person($name, $address, $age) {
    $this->name = $name;
    $this->address = $address;
    $this->age = $age;
  }
}

class Employee extends Person {
  var $position, $salary;

   function Employee($name, $address, $age, $position, $salary) {
     $this->Person($name, $address, $age);
     $this->position = $position;
```

Remember

Don't forget that in a class, variables are called 'properties' and functions are called 'methods'.